

## ♦ DECK · 46 CARDS

Two decks, **no Diamond suit**.

Keep A · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 · J · Q + Jokers:

**6×** each of A, 2, 3, 4, 5, J

**4×** Ordinary Queens · **2×** Heart Queens

**2×** Big Jokers · **2×** Small Jokers

## ♦ SETUP

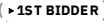
Deal **18** cards to each player. Set the other **10 aside face down** as the set-aside pile, unused except as noted by certain contracts.

## ♦ BID &amp; PLAY

**Bid.** The player with fewer points bids first (random on hand 1). Bid higher to stay in. A pass closes the auction. The last, highest bidder becomes declarer and must play the contract they bid.

**Play.** Declarer aims to shed out before the defender. On a turn, lead any legal play, beat the current combination, shovel, or pass. When one player passes, the other leads next. The hand ends when a player empties their hand, or earlier through contract failure or escape.

## ♦ CONTRACTS

| CONTRACT                                                                                                                                                                                       | IF DECLARED                                                                                                                      | WIN / LOSS     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
|  <b>Quiet</b><br>             | No one declares. First to shed out wins.                                                                                         | <b>9</b>       |
|  <b>Breakaway</b><br> ★       | No added conditions.                                                                                                             | <b>15 / 10</b> |
|  <b>Forced Shovel</b><br>     | Declarer must not play Aces except to shovel or in their final play. Whenever a legal shovel is available, declarer must shovel. | <b>21 / 14</b> |
|  <b>Buried Treasure</b><br> ★ | Reveal the top 3 set-aside. Defender keeps 1 or 2, declarer takes the rest.                                                      | <b>27 / 18</b> |
|  <b>Red Finish</b><br> ★     | Declarer's final play must contain a Heart Queen.                                                                                | <b>42 / 28</b> |
|  <b>The Chase</b><br>     | Declarer takes the top 3 set-aside, then must shed out before the defender is down to 2 cards after a turn.                      | <b>54 / 36</b> |
|  <b>Shutout</b><br>       | Declarer sheds out before the defender plays a single card, even a shovel.                                                       | <b>84 / 56</b> |

**Win** = declarer succeeds. **Loss** = defender scores. Scorer also gets **+1 per card** left in the loser's hand (capped at the contract score earned, no bonus for Shutout). Play to **150 or 250** points, or to any previously agreed number of hands or points.

## ♦ CARD RANK



**Heart Queens** stand apart: they pair only with each other, never with ordinary Queens. **Jokers** play as singles or same-kind pairs only (never in runs).

## ♦ LEGAL PLAYS

| TYPE                  | MADE OF                                                         |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Single</b>         | One card.                                                       |
| <b>Pair</b>           | Two of a rank. Heart Queens & same-kind Jokers may pair.        |
| <b>Set</b>            | Three to six of a rank. Heart Queens & Jokers cannot form sets. |
| <b>Single Run</b>     | 4 or 5 consecutive singles using A · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 only.        |
| <b>Connected Sets</b> | 3+ consecutive equal-size groups using A · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 only.  |

Match the **type and shape**, then play a higher rank. Runs and connected sets compare by their highest card or group. **No bombs, no cross-type beating.**

## ♦ SHOVEL · ACES

| PLAY                       | CAPTURE       |
|----------------------------|---------------|
| <b>A</b> →                 | a pair        |
| <b>A · A</b> →             | a triple      |
| <b>A · A · A</b> →         | a 4-of-a-kind |
| <b>A · A · A · A</b> →     | a 5-of-a-kind |
| <b>A · A · A · A · A</b> → | a 6-of-a-kind |

Play Aces to **capture** pairs and sets. The Aces become the **current play**. **Heart Queens** and **Jokers** cannot be shovelled.